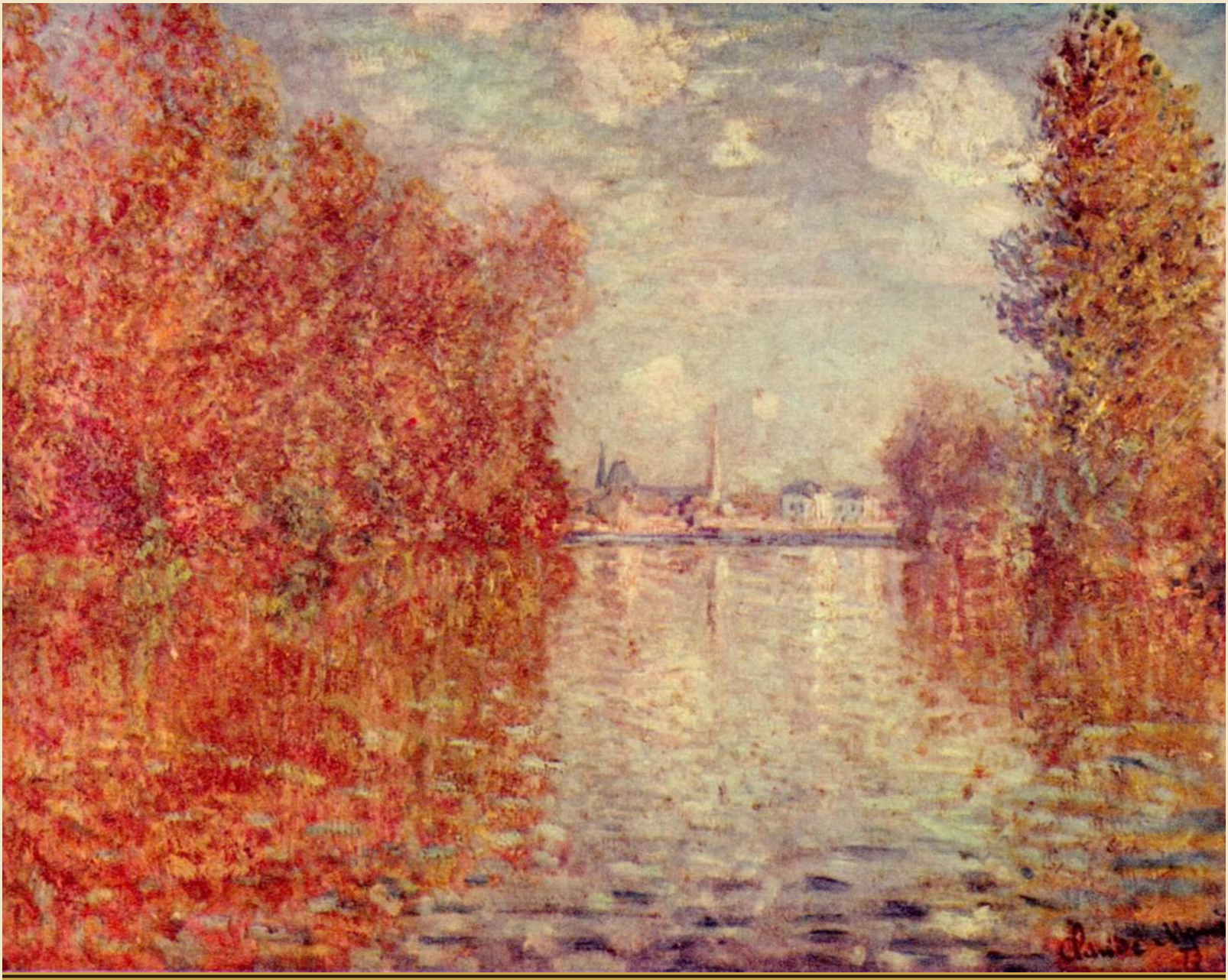


Siddhartha

Hermann Hesse · 1922

English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets (Project Gutenberg #2500; Standard Ebooks edition)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

12 chapter lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 15 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 3 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC

Cover: Claude Monet, Autumn at Argenteuil (1873). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–12), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
4. Whole-book test and answer key
5. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Translated from the German by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets for Project Gutenberg (ebook #2500); this text is the Standard Ebooks edition, believed to be in the U.S. public domain, with Standard Ebooks' own contributions dedicated under CC0 1.0. Word-choice analysis studies the translators' English, not Hesse's German.

Content note for teachers: Cultural representation: Siddhartha is a German novelist's adaptation of Hindu and Buddhist ideas, not a sacred or authoritative text. Discuss whose perspective shapes the story, and frame the caste system as a system of harm.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (also 7–8; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these novels are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 3. **Class days:** 15 × 90 minutes (12 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Siddhartha suggest about the search for self-knowledge?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about experience versus teaching?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the unity of all things?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about the river and time?
- What does Siddhartha suggest about love and attachment?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards and frameworks

- **Common Core:** RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4
  Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org
- **Indiana 2023:** 7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1
  Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE
- **Dual Credit (Indiana College Core):** ICC-WC-1.1, ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.7
  Indiana College Core, Written Communication outcomes 1.1–1.7 (CHE guidance); ICC-WC-x IDs are ours
- **AP:** AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN
  AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)
- **Cambridge International:** CAIE-9695.AO1, CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4, CAIE-9695.AO5
  Cambridge International AS & A Level Literature in English 9695 assessment objectives (our summaries; cambridgeinternational.org)
- **Liber et Libri program outcomes:** LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1
  Liber et Libri program outcome, not an official standard

Primary codes: RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, RL.7.2
Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80

8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	The Son of the Brahmin With the Samanas Gotama Awakening Kamala	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the search for self-knowledge* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	*Socratic seminar on the search for self-knowledge* With the Childlike People Sansara By the River The Ferryman	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*experience versus teaching* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the search for self-knowledge • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	The Son Om Govinda *Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final essay workshop and submission*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the unity of all things* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final essay workshop and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: The Son of the Brahmin

Focus: restlessness despite privilege

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha, a gifted Brahmin's son loved by everyone, including his devoted friend Govinda, feels that the teachings and rituals of his elders have not given him inner peace. He asks his father for permission to join the wandering ascetics called Samanas; his father refuses, but Siddhartha stands silently all night until his father consents. Govinda goes with him.

Background: Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India. The caste system ranked people by birth and caused lasting harm and exclusion, especially to those placed at the bottom or outside it; discuss it as a system of injustice, not a neutral backdrop. the Upanishads and the idea of Atman (the inner self) shape Siddhartha's questions. Hesse, a German writer, studied Indian thought and wrote during the years after World War I.

Significance: The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are ablution, focused, ascetics, pristine, invocation. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution." In this sentence it means: a ritual washing of the body. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Brahmins were the priestly caste in ancient India. The caste system ranked people by birth and caused lasting harm and exclusion, especially to those placed at the bottom or outside it; discuss it as a system of injustice, not a neutral backdrop. the Upanishads and the idea of Atman (the inner self) shape Siddhartha's questions. Hesse, a German writer, studied Indian thought and wrote during the years after World War I. Why does this chapter matter? The opening establishes the novel's central pattern: knowledge received from teachers cannot replace knowledge gained by living. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to restlessness despite privilege? I circle "ablution", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose. The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution. He called Siddhartha's name. Siddhartha did not answer. Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe. Thus sat he, wrapped up in contemplation, thinking Om, his soul sent after the Brahman as an arrow.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Setting, Symbolism: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how The Son of the Brahmin develops the idea of restlessness despite privilege. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about restlessness despite privilege, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes restlessness despite privilege. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
ablution (noun)	a ritual washing of the body	*The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
focused (verb)	fixed; concentrated (on a target)	*Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ascetics (noun)	people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons	*I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pristine (adjective)	completely free from dirt or contamination	*Was not Atman in him, did not the pristine source spring from his heart?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
invocation (noun)	a prayer asking God's help as part of a religious service	*The sacrifices and the invocation of the gods were excellent —but was that all?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
protruding (verb)	extend out or project in space	*Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
partaking (verb)	have some of the qualities or attributes of something	*For a long time, Siddhartha had been partaking in the discussions of the wise men, practising debate with Govinda, practising with Govinda the art of reflection, the service of meditation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wavered (verb)	pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness	*Siddhartha wavered to the side, as he tried to walk.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
crouched (verb)	bend one's back forward from the waist on down	*As he slowly left on stiff legs in the first light of day the still quiet town, a shadow rose near the last hut, who had crouched there, and joined the pilgrim—Govinda.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

merciless (adjective)	having or showing no mercy	*Behind them blew a hot scent of quiet passion, of destructive service, of merciless self-denial.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why isn't Siddhartha satisfied, even though he is admired and successful?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What is Siddhartha's family background?
   A. He is a merchant's son
   B. He is the son of a Brahmin
   C. He is a ferryman's son
   D. He is a prince
2. Who is Siddhartha's closest friend?
   A. Govinda
   B. Gotama
   C. Kamaswami
   D. Vasudeva
3. Whom does Siddhartha want to join?
   A. The soldiers
   B. The Brahmin priests
   C. The Samanas
   D. The merchants
4. How does Siddhartha win his father's permission?
   A. By arguing loudly
   B. By fasting for a month
   C. By standing silently all night
   D. By running away
5. What does Siddhartha seek that rituals have not given him?
   A. Wealth
   B. Fame
   C. A wife

D. Inner peace and knowledge of Atman

6. In the line “The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening’s ablution.”, what does “ablution” most nearly mean?
   A. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons
   B. fixed; concentrated (on a target)
   C. a ritual washing of the body
   D. completely free from dirt or contamination
7. In the line “Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe.”, what does “focused” most nearly mean?
   A. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons
   B. fixed; concentrated (on a target)
   C. a ritual washing of the body
   D. completely free from dirt or contamination

Answer key: 1. B (He is the son of a Brahmin); 2. A (Govinda); 3. C (The Samanas); 4. C (By standing silently all night); 5. D (Inner peace and knowledge of Atman); 6. C (a ritual washing of the body); 7. B (fixed; concentrated (on a target))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Son of the Brahmin,” how does Hesse show restlessness despite privilege? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In The Son of the Brahmin, how does Hesse develop the idea of restlessness despite privilege? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Son of the Brahmin develops the idea of restlessness despite privilege. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Son of the Brahmin (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding

of restlessness despite privilege. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Son of the Brahmin suggests about restlessness despite privilege. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in The Son of the Brahmin to complicate the reader's understanding of restlessness despite privilege. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Son of the Brahmin within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of restlessness despite privilege responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Son of the Brahmin alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of restlessness despite privilege follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Son of the Brahmin and its treatment of restlessness despite privilege. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Son of the Brahmin as evidence for a larger claim about restlessness despite privilege in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Son of the Brahmin as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of restlessness despite privilege. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *I came to tell you that it is my longing to leave your house tomorrow and go to the ascetics.*

As used in the text, what does the word "ascetics" most nearly mean?

A. bend one's back forward from the waist on down

B. having or showing no mercy

C. people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons

D. pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness

2. *After the usual time of the exercise in meditation had passed, Govinda rose. The evening had come, it was time to perform the evening's ablution. He called Siddhartha's name. Siddhartha did not answer. Siddhartha sat there lost in thought, his eyes were rigidly focused towards a very distant target, the tip of his tongue was protruding a little between the teeth, he seemed not to breathe. Thus sat he, wrapped up in contemplation, thinking Om, his soul sent after the Brahman as an arrow.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Son of the Brahmin"?

A. Wisdom cannot be taught

B. Learning from the river

C. Detachment among the childlike people

D. Restlessness despite privilege

SAT key: 1. C (people who give up comforts for spiritual reasons); 2. D (Restlessness despite privilege)

Lesson 2: With the Samanas

Focus: self-denial as a path

Teacher only · spoilers

With the Samanas, Siddhartha learns fasting, enduring pain, and meditations that let his self pass into animals and objects. Yet after three years he concludes these are only escapes from the self, not true release. When rumors spread of Gotama, the Buddha, he and Govinda leave; Siddhartha masters the old Samana with his gaze before departing.

Background: Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India.

Significance: Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are numbing, nirvana, festering, cowered, numbness. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life." In this sentence it means: a dulling of feeling or pain. Word histories: "nirvana": From Sanskrit nirvana "extinction," literally "a blowing out," from nir- "out" + va- "to blow." For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Asceticism—strict self-denial—was a widespread spiritual practice in ancient India. Why does this chapter matter? Siddhartha discovers that discipline alone can become another form of illusion, a key turn in his quest. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for theme.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Silently, Siddhartha exposed himself to burning rays of the sun directly above, glowing with pain, glowing with thirst, and stood there, until he neither felt any pain nor thirst any more." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to self-denial as a path? I circle "festering", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find theme, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of theme. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Silently, Siddhartha exposed himself to burning rays of the sun directly above, glowing with pain, glowing with thirst, and stood there, until he neither felt any pain nor thirst any more. Silently, he stood there in the rainy season, from his hair the water was dripping over freezing shoulders, over freezing hips and legs, and the penitent stood there, until he could not feel the cold in his shoulders and legs any more, until they were silent, until they were quiet. Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Theme, Characterization, Imagery: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how With the Samanas develops the idea of self-denial as a path. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about self-denial as a path, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes self-denial as a path. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
numbing (noun)	a dulling of feeling or pain	*It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nirvana (noun)	in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering	*And Siddhartha: "He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana.*	"nirvana": From Sanskrit nirvana "extinction," literally "a blowing out," from nir- "out" + va- "to blow." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/nirvana)
festering (adjective)	infected and full of pus	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cowered (verb)	crouch or curl up	*Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
numbness (noun)	partial or total lack of sensation in a part of the body; a symptom of nerve damage or dysfunction	*We find comfort, we find numbness, we learn feats, to deceive others.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
thirsted (verb)	longed for something strongly	*I always thirsted for knowledge, I have always been full of questions.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
breaths (noun)		*Siddhartha sat upright and learned to breathe sparingly, learned to get along*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

	the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing	*with only few breaths, learned to stop breathing.*	
submerged (verb)	sink below the surface; go under or as if under water	*He possessed, so the believers said, the highest enlightenment, he remembered his previous lives, he had reached the nirvana and never returned into the cycle, was never again submerged in the murky river of physical forms.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mumbled (verb)	talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice	*And Govinda mumbled a verse to himself, a verse from an Upanishad:*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
meditate (verb)	reflect deeply on a subject	*He'll turn seventy and eighty, and you and me, we will grow just as old and will do our exercises, and will fast, and will meditate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha calls the Samanas' practices a 'brief numbing.' Do you agree?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. What do the Samanas practice?
   A. Farming
   B. Fasting and self-denial
   C. Warfare
   D. Trading goods
2. What can Siddhartha do in meditation?
   A. See the future
   B. Fly
   C. Let his self pass into animals and things
   D. Speak to the dead
3. What does he conclude about these practices?
   A. They bring wealth

B. They should be taught to all

C. They are only temporary escapes from the self

D. They are perfect

4. Who is rumored to have attained enlightenment?

A. Gotama, the Buddha

B. Vasudeva

C. Kamala

D. His father

5. How does Siddhartha respond to the old Samana's anger?

A. He silences him with his gaze

B. He fights him

C. He promises to return

D. He apologizes

6. In the line "It is fleeing from the self, it is a short escape of the agony of being a self, it is a short numbing of the senses against the pain and the pointlessness of life.", what does "numbing" most nearly mean?

A. infected and full of pus

B. a dulling of feeling or pain

C. in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering

D. crouch or curl up

7. In the line "And Siddhartha: "He has lived for sixty years and has not reached the nirvana.", what does "nirvana" most nearly mean?

A. crouch or curl up

B. infected and full of pus

C. in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering

D. a dulling of feeling or pain

Answer key: 1. B (Fasting and self-denial); 2. C (Let his self pass into animals and things); 3. C (They are only temporary escapes from the self); 4. A (Gotama, the Buddha); 5. A (He silences him with his gaze); 6. B (a dulling of feeling or pain); 7. C (in Buddhism and Hinduism, release from the cycle of rebirth and suffering)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "With the Samanas," how does Hesse show self-denial as a path? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): In With the Samanas, how does Hesse develop the idea of self-denial as a path? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the

English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how With the Samanas develops the idea of self-denial as a path. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of With the Samanas (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of self-denial as a path. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what With the Samanas suggests about self-denial as a path. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses theme in With the Samanas to complicate the reader's understanding of self-denial as a path. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate With the Samanas within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of self-denial as a path responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read With the Samanas alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of self-denial as a path follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to With the Samanas and its treatment of self-denial as a path. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads With the Samanas as evidence for a larger claim about self-denial as a path in

Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads With the Samanas as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of self-denial as a path. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “festering” most nearly mean?

   A. infected and full of pus

   B. reflect deeply on a subject

   C. talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice

   D. sink below the surface; go under or as if under water

2. *Silently, Siddhartha exposed himself to burning rays of the sun directly above, glowing with pain, glowing with thirst, and stood there, until he neither felt any pain nor thirst any more. Silently, he stood there in the rainy season, from his hair the water was dripping over freezing shoulders, over freezing hips and legs, and the penitent stood there, until he could not feel the cold in his shoulders and legs any more, until they were silent, until they were quiet. Silently, he cowered in the thorny bushes, blood dripped from the burning skin, from festering wounds dripped pus, and Siddhartha stayed rigidly, stayed motionless, until no blood flowed any more, until nothing stung any more, until nothing burned any more.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “With the Samanas”?

   A. Restlessness despite privilege

   B. Self-denial as a path

   C. Entering the city and learning love

   D. Wisdom cannot be taught

SAT key: 1. A (infected and full of pus); 2. B (Self-denial as a path)

Lesson 3: Gotama

Focus: the teacher and the teaching

Teacher only · spoilers

In the grove of Jetavana, Siddhartha and Govinda hear Gotama teach. Govinda joins the Buddha's followers. Siddhartha deeply admires Gotama but explains to him that enlightenment cannot be taught in words; each person must find it alone. Gotama warns him gently against too much cleverness, and Siddhartha leaves, feeling Gotama has taken his friend but given him himself.

Background: Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name.

Significance: The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are novices, discard, enticed, venerated, exhaled. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices." In this sentence it means: beginners in a religious order. Word histories: "discard": dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off." "venerated": From Latin venerari "to revere, worship," related to venus "love, desire." (Not from venire "to come.") For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Gotama is Siddhartha Gautama, the historical Buddha; Hesse deliberately gives his hero the Buddha's own name. Why does this chapter matter? The parting of friends dramatizes the novel's thesis that wisdom must be lived, not adopted. Write down one question you want answered.*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the teacher and the teaching? I circle "dangling", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly. With a hidden smile, quiet, calm, somewhat resembling a healthy child, the Buddha walked, wore the robe and placed his feet just as all of his monks did, according to a precise rule. But his face and his walk, his quietly lowered glance, his quietly dangling hand and even every finger of his quietly dangling hand expressed peace, expressed perfection, did not search, did not imitate, breathed softly in an unwithering calm, in an unwithering light, an untouchable peace.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Theme, Conflict: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Gotama develops the idea of the teacher and the teaching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the teacher and the teaching, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the teacher and the teaching. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
novices (noun)	beginners in a religious order	*Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
discard (verb)	to reject; to throw away	*There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.*	“discard”: dis- "away" + card (playing card): originally "to throw a card out of one's hand," then "to cast off." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/discard)
enticed (verb)	tempted; attracted	*No teachings will entice me any more, since this man's teachings have not enticed me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
venerated (verb)	regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of	*Never before had Siddhartha venerated a person so much, never before had he loved a person as much as this one.*	“venerated”: From Latin venerari "to revere, worship," related to venus "love, desire." (Not from venire "to come.") (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/venerate)
exhaled (verb)	expel air	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
glistened (verb)	be shiny, as if wet	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	“glistened”: From Old English glisnian "to gleam," a Germanic word related to glitter and gleam. (Not from Latin tenere.) (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/glisten)
	frankness; honesty		Student look-up (not yet verified)

openness (noun)		*With half of a smile, with an unwavering openness and kindness, Gotama looked into the stranger's eyes and bid him to leave with a hardly noticeable gesture.*	
equanimity (noun)	steadiness of mind under stress	*The Buddha's eyes quietly looked to the ground; quietly, in perfect equanimity his inscrutable face was smiling.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dangling (verb)	hang freely	*But attentively he looked at Gotama's head, his shoulders, his feet, his quietly dangling hand, and it seemed to him as if every joint of every finger of this hand was of these teachings, spoke of, breathed of, exhaled the fragrant of, glistened of truth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
renounced (verb)	give up, such as power, as of monarchs and emperors, or duties and obligations	*You have renounced your home and your parents, renounced your birth and possessions, renounced your free will, renounced all friendship.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Siddhartha refuse to follow even a teacher he admires?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the unity of all things?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. Where do they hear Gotama teach?
   A. In a city market
   B. In a palace
   C. By the river
   D. In the grove of Jetavana
2. What does Govinda decide?
   A. To become a merchant

B. To return home

C. To follow Siddhartha

D. To join Gotama's followers

3. What does Siddhartha tell Gotama?

A. He will return later

B. He wants to be a monk

C. Enlightenment cannot be taught in words

D. His teachings are false

4. What does Gotama warn Siddhartha about?

A. Loving too much

B. Being too poor

C. Being too clever

D. Being lazy

5. What does Siddhartha feel Gotama gave him?

A. A robe

B. A mantra

C. Himself

D. A begging bowl

6. In the line “Then Govinda broke loose, embraced once again his childhood friend and left with the novices.”, what does “novices” most nearly mean?

A. beginners in a religious order

B. regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of

C. to reject; to throw away

D. tempted; attracted

7. In the line “There is nothing to opinions, they may be beautiful or ugly, smart or foolish, everyone can support them or discard them.”, what does “discard” most nearly mean?

A. beginners in a religious order

B. to reject; to throw away

C. tempted; attracted

D. regard with feelings of respect and reverence; consider hallowed or exalted or be in awe of

Answer key: 1. D (In the grove of Jetavana); 2. D (To join Gotama's followers); 3. C (Enlightenment cannot be taught in words); 4. C (Being too clever); 5. C (Himself); 6. A (beginners in a religious order); 7. B (to reject; to throw away)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Gotama,” how does Hesse show the teacher and the teaching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Gotama, how does Hesse develop the idea of the teacher and the teaching? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Gotama develops the idea of the teacher and the teaching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Gotama (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the teacher and the teaching. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Gotama suggests about the teacher and the teaching. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in Gotama to complicate the reader's understanding of the teacher and the teaching. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Gotama within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the teacher and the teaching responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Gotama alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the teacher and the teaching follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Gotama and its treatment of the teacher and the teaching. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Gotama as evidence for a larger claim about the teacher and the teaching in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Gotama as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the teacher and the teaching. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *No teachings will entice me any more, since this man's teachings have not enticed me.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "enticed" most nearly mean?

   A. tempted; attracted

   B. hang freely

   C. give up, such as power, as of monarchs and emperors, or duties and obligations

   D. steadiness of mind under stress

2. *The Buddha went on his way, modestly and deep in his thoughts, his calm face was neither happy nor sad, it seemed to smile quietly and inwardly. With a hidden smile, quiet, calm, somewhat resembling a healthy child, the Buddha walked, wore the robe and placed his feet just as all of his monks did, according to a precise rule. But his face and his walk, his quietly lowered glance, his quietly dangling hand and even every finger of his quietly dangling hand expressed peace, expressed perfection, did not search, did not imitate, breathed softly in an unwithering calm, in an unwithering light, an untouchable peace.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Gotama"?

   A. Hearing the many voices

   B. The teacher and the teaching

   C. Wisdom cannot be taught

   D. Learning from the river

SAT key: 1. A (tempted; attracted); 2. B (The teacher and the teaching)

Lesson 4: Awakening

Focus: awakening to the world

Teacher only · spoilers

Walking away, Siddhartha realizes he has always fled from himself and resolves to learn from himself. Suddenly the world appears new and beautiful—colors, rivers, forests—no longer illusion but reality to be experienced. He feels a chill of loneliness: he is no longer a Brahmin or a Samana, but he will not go home.

Background: In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya.

Significance: This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are dissect, inhaled, deceptions, heading, teachings. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part." In this sentence it means: to cut apart in order to examine closely. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. In Hindu thought, Maya is the veil of illusion over the world; Siddhartha turns away from seeing the world as Maya. Why does this chapter matter? This epiphany marks the end of Part One and turns him toward sensory life. Write down one question you want answered.*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for imagery.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to awakening to the world? I circle "perfected", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find imagery, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for imagery.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of imagery. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him. He pondered about this sensation, which filled him completely, as he was slowly walking along. He pondered deeply, like diving into a deep water he let himself sink down to the ground of the sensation, down to the place where the causes lie, because to identify the causes, so it seemed to him, is the very essence of thinking, and by this alone sensations turn into realizations and are not lost, but become entities and start to emit like rays of light what is inside of them.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Imagery, Symbolism, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Awakening develops the idea of awakening to the world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about awakening to the world, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes awakening to the world. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
dissect (verb)	to cut apart in order to examine closely	*I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inhaled (verb)	breathed in	*Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
deceptions (noun)	tricks; false appearances	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
heading (verb)	going toward	*And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home, no longer to his father, no longer back.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
teachings (noun)	ideas or principles taught by someone	*He had also left the last teacher who had appeared on his path, even him, the highest and wisest teacher, the most holy one, Buddha, he had left him, had to part with him, was not able to accept his teachings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
strides (noun)	a step in walking or running	*And it was not long until he walked again in long strides, started to proceed swiftly and impatiently, heading no longer for home, no longer to his father, no longer back.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
workers (noun)	a person who works at a specific occupation	*There was no nobleman who did not belong to the noblemen, no worker that did not belong to the workers, and found refuge with them, shared their life, spoke their language.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
perfected (verb)	make perfect or complete	*When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
symbols (noun)	an arbitrary sign (written or printed) that has	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and*	

	acquired a conventional significance	*call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
coincidence (noun)	an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental	*"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What changes in how Siddhartha sees the world in this chapter?
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the river and time?

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from?
   A. His father
   B. The Samanas
   C. Himself
   D. The Buddha
2. How does the world appear to him?
   A. New and beautiful
   B. Frightening
   C. Unreal
   D. Grey and dull
3. What does he feel after the awakening?
   A. A cold loneliness
   B. Anger
   C. Pride in his caste
   D. Hunger
4. Does Siddhartha go home to his father?
   A. He sends a letter
   B. No, he moves forward alone
   C. Yes, to say goodbye

D. Yes, at once

5. What idea does he reject here?
   A. Seeing the world as mere illusion
   B. Self-knowledge
   C. Learning from nature
   D. Being alone
6. In the line “I searched Atman, I searched Brahman, I was willing to dissect my self and peel off all of its layers, to find the core of all peels in its unknown interior, the Atman, life, the divine part, the ultimate part.”, what does “dissect” most nearly mean?
   A. breathed in
   B. tricks; false appearances
   C. going toward
   D. to cut apart in order to examine closely
7. In the line “Deeply, he inhaled, and for a moment, he felt cold and shivered.”, what does “inhaled” most nearly mean?
   A. tricks; false appearances
   B. to cut apart in order to examine closely
   C. going toward
   D. breathed in

Answer key: 1. C (Himself); 2. A (New and beautiful); 3. A (A cold loneliness); 4. B (No, he moves forward alone); 5. A (Seeing the world as mere illusion); 6. D (to cut apart in order to examine closely); 7. D (breathed in)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Awakening,” how does Hesse show awakening to the world? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Awakening, how does Hesse develop the idea of awakening to the world? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Awakening develops the idea of awakening to the world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Awakening (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of awakening to the world. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Awakening suggests about awakening to the world. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses imagery in Awakening to complicate the reader's understanding of awakening to the world. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Awakening within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of awakening to the world responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Awakening alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of awakening to the world follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Awakening and its treatment of awakening to the world. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Awakening as evidence for a larger claim about awakening to the world in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Awakening as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of awakening to the world. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *"When someone reads a text, wants to discover its meaning, he will not scorn the symbols and letters and call them deceptions, coincidence, and worthless hull, but he will read them, he will study and love them, letter by letter.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "deceptions" most nearly mean?

   A. an arbitrary sign (written or printed) that has acquired a conventional significance

   B. an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental

   C. tricks; false appearances

   D. make perfect or complete

2. *When Siddhartha left the grove, where the Buddha, the perfected one, stayed behind, where Govinda stayed behind, then he felt that in this grove his past life also stayed behind and parted from him. He pondered about this sensation, which filled him completely, as he was slowly walking along. He pondered deeply, like diving into a deep water he let himself sink down to the ground of the sensation, down to the place where the causes lie, because to identify the causes, so it seemed to him, is the very essence of thinking, and by this alone sensations turn into realizations and are not lost, but become entities and start to emit like rays of light what is inside of them.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Awakening"?

   A. Detachment among the childlike people

   B. The pain of a father's love

   C. Awakening to the world

   D. Self-denial as a path

SAT key: 1. C (tricks; false appearances); 2. C (Awakening to the world)

Lesson 5: Kamala

Focus: entering the city and learning love

Content note (sexual content): Kamala is a courtesan and teaches Siddhartha “the art of love”. Keep discussion on desire and attachment as ideas; no detail is needed.
Student preview: This chapter refers to a romantic and sexual relationship.
Suggested language: “What does Siddhartha want from Kamala, and what does he learn?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha dreams of Govinda becoming a woman, crosses a river with a kind ferryman (Vasudeva) who predicts his return, and reaches a city where he sees the beautiful courtesan Kamala. She tells him he needs fine clothes, shoes and money; he learns quickly and, through her, gains a position with the merchant Kamaswami. Kamala becomes his teacher in love.

Background: Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected.

Significance: The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: This chapter refers to a romantic and sexual relationship.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are disembarking, seashells, shimmered, pouches, cistern. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: ““I thank you, my benefactor,” spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.” In this sentence it means: getting off a boat. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Courtesans in ancient India could be educated, wealthy and respected. Why does this chapter matter? The ferryman's prophecy and the river crossing foreshadow the novel's final setting. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""I thank you, my benefactor,"" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to entering the city and learning love? I circle "disembarking", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river. "I have no gift I could give you for your hospitality, my dear, and also no payment for your work. I am a man without a home, a son of a Brahmin and a Samana."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Symbolism, Setting: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Kamala develops the idea of entering the city and learning love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about entering the city and learning love, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes entering the city and learning love. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disembarking (verb)	getting off a boat	*"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
seashells (noun)	the shells of sea creatures	*In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shimmered (verb)	shone with a soft, wavering light	*It intoxicated him and rendered him unconscious.—When Siddhartha woke up, the pale river shimmered through the door of the hut, and in the forest, a dark call of an owl resounded deeply and pleasantly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pouches (noun)	a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things	*Many young men come to me, and there are also sons of Brahmins among them, but they come in beautiful clothes, they come in fine shoes, they have perfume in their hair and money in their pouches.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cistern (noun)	a tank for storing water	*Differently the sun burnt the head, differently the shade of the forest cooled him down, differently the stream and the cistern, the pumpkin and the banana tasted.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rainbows (noun)	an arc of colored light in the sky caused by refraction of the sun's rays by rain	*He saw trees, stars, animals, clouds, rainbows, rocks, herbs, flowers, stream and river, the glistening dew in the bushes in the morning, distant high mountains which were blue and pale, birds sang and bees, wind silverishly blew through the rice field.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
clanged (verb)	make a loud noise	*Kamala loudly clapped her hands, so that the golden bracelets clanged.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
jackals (noun)	wild dogs that hunt or scavenge	*"Why should I be afraid of a Samana, a stupid Samana from the forest, who is coming from the jackals and doesn't even know yet what women are?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
peacocks (noun)	male peafowl, birds with large, colorful tail feathers	*Kamala smiled, played with her fan of peacocks' feathers, and asked: "And only to tell me this, Siddhartha has come to me?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
courtesan (noun)	a woman paid to be the companion of wealthy men	*When, late in the afternoon, beautiful Kamala approached her grove in her sedan-chair, Siddhartha was standing at the entrance, made a bow and received the courtesan's greeting.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha says he can 'think, wait and fast.' Why are these powerful skills?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with love and attachment?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river?
   A. Govinda
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Kamaswami
   D. Gotama
2. What does the ferryman predict?
   A. He will be rich
   B. Siddhartha will return
   C. He will die young
   D. He will become a monk
3. Who is Kamala?
   A. Siddhartha's sister
   B. A merchant's wife
   C. A beautiful courtesan
   D. A Samana
4. What three skills does Siddhartha name?
   A. Fighting, riding and hunting
   B. Reading, writing and singing
   C. Trading, cooking and building
   D. Thinking, waiting and fasting
5. Who gives Siddhartha work?
   A. The merchant Kamaswami
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Govinda
   D. His father

6. In the line ““I thank you, my benefactor,” spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river.”, what does “disembarking” most nearly mean?
   A. the shells of sea creatures
   B. a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things
   C. shone with a soft, wavering light
   D. getting off a boat
7. In the line “In front of the mud cottages, children were rolling about in the street, were playing with pumpkinseeds and seashells, screamed and wrestled, but they all timidly fled from the unknown Samana.”, what does “seashells” most nearly mean?
   A. getting off a boat
   B. a small or medium size container for holding or carrying things
   C. shone with a soft, wavering light
   D. the shells of sea creatures

Answer key: 1. B (Vasudeva); 2. B (Siddhartha will return); 3. C (A beautiful courtesan); 4. D (Thinking, waiting and fasting); 5. A (The merchant Kamaswami); 6. D (getting off a boat); 7. D (the shells of sea creatures)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Kamala,” how does Hesse show entering the city and learning love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Kamala, how does Hesse develop the idea of entering the city and learning love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Kamala develops the idea of entering the city and learning love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Kamala (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of entering the city and learning love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Kamala suggests about entering the city and learning love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in Kamala to complicate the reader's understanding of entering the city and learning love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Kamala within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of entering the city and learning love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Kamala alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of entering the city and learning love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Kamala and its treatment of entering the city and learning love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Kamala as evidence for a larger claim about entering the city and learning love in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Kamala as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of entering the city and learning love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *It intoxicated him and rendered him unconscious.—When Siddhartha woke up, the pale river shimmered through the door of the hut, and in the forest, a dark call of an owl resounded deeply and pleasantly.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “shimmered” most nearly mean?

   A. shone with a soft, wavering light

   B. male peafowl, birds with large, colorful tail feathers

   C. a woman paid to be the companion of wealthy men

D. wild dogs that hunt or scavenge

2. *"I thank you, my benefactor," spoke Siddhartha, disembarking on the other side of the river. "I have no gift I could give you for your hospitality, my dear, and also no payment for your work. I am a man without a home, a son of a Brahmin and a Samana."*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Kamala"?

A. Entering the city and learning love

B. The pain of a father's love

C. The teacher and the teaching

D. Detachment among the childlike people

SAT key: 1. A (shone with a soft, wavering light); 2. A (Entering the city and learning love)

Lesson 6: With the Childlike People

Focus: detachment among the childlike people

Content note (sexual content, condescending language): Continues the relationship with Kamala; the narrator calls ordinary people “childlike people”. Question that condescension.
Student preview: The chapter continues the relationship and calls ordinary people 'childlike'.
Suggested language: “Is Siddhartha right to look down on the 'childlike people'?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha works for Kamaswami but treats business as a game, caring little for profit, which irritates the merchant yet makes Siddhartha successful. He watches ordinary people—the 'childlike people'—with amusement as they suffer over money and desire. Kamala teaches him the art of love, and they agree that neither of them can truly love.

Background: Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire.

Significance: Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: The chapter continues the relationship and calls ordinary people 'childlike'.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are businesses, storage, hastiness, besiege, tumbles. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: “Besides from this, Siddhartha’s interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.” In this sentence it means: jobs and daily affairs. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Hesse contrasts spiritual detachment with worldly attachment, echoing Buddhist teaching on desire. Why does this chapter matter? Siddhartha's superiority is ironic: he is beginning to become what he looks down on. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""It is very good, sir." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to detachment among the childlike people? I circle "besiege", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"It is very good, sir. When a person has nothing to eat, fasting is the smartest thing he could do. When, for example, Siddhartha hadn't learned to fast, he would have to accept any kind of service before that day is up, whether it may be with you or wherever, because hunger would force him to do so. But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it. This, sir, is what fasting is good for."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Irony, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how With the Childlike People develops the idea of detachment among the childlike people. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about detachment among the childlike people, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes detachment among the childlike people. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
businesses (noun)	jobs and daily affairs	*Besides from this, Siddhartha's interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
storage (noun)	places where goods are kept	*Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him calculations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hastiness (noun)	acting too quickly	*But like this, I've had a few good days, I've learned, had joy, I've neither harmed myself nor others by annoyance and hastiness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
besiege (verb)	surround so as to force to give up	*But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tumbles (verb)	falls	*Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and is turning around through the air, and wavers, and tumbles to the ground.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
flexible (adjective)	able to bend easily	*Her body was flexible like that of a jaguar and like the bow of a hunter; he who had learned from her how to make love, was knowledgeable of many forms of lust, many secrets.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
admonished (verb)	warned or scolded gently	*At times he felt, deep in his chest, a dying, quiet voice, which admonished him quietly, lamented quietly; he hardly perceived it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
shipping (verb)	transport commercially	*He soon saw that Siddhartha knew little about rice and wool, shipping and trade, but that he acted in a fortunate manner, and that Siddhartha surpassed him, the merchant, in calmness and equanimity, and in the art of listening and deeply understanding previously unknown people.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
carpets (noun)	floor covering consisting of a piece of thick heavy fabric (usually with nap or pile)	*Siddhartha went to Kamaswami the merchant, he was directed into a rich house, servants led him between precious carpets into a chamber, where he awaited the master of the house.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
calmness (noun)	steadiness of mind under stress	*He soon saw that Siddhartha knew little about rice and wool, shipping and trade, but that he acted in a fortunate manner, and that Siddhartha surpassed him, the merchant, in calmness and equanimity, and in the art of listening and deeply understanding previously unknown people.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Siddhartha calls others 'childlike.' Is he being wise or arrogant?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. How does Siddhartha treat business?
   A. As a game he does not take seriously
   B. As sacred work
   C. As a burden he hates
   D. As a way to help the poor
2. What does he call ordinary people?
   A. The childlike people
   B. The fallen ones
   C. The masters
   D. The sleepers
3. How does Kamaswami feel about Siddhartha's attitude?
   A. Irritated but impressed by results
   B. Indifferent
   C. Afraid
   D. Delighted
4. What do Siddhartha and Kamala agree about?
   A. They will marry
   B. Neither can truly love
   C. They will leave the city
   D. They should become Samanas
5. What is ironic about his view of others?
   A. He is slowly becoming like them
   B. He is their king
   C. He is poorer than them
   D. He does not see them

6. In the line “Besides from this, Siddhartha’s interest and curiosity was only concerned with the people, whose businesses, crafts, worries, pleasures, and acts of foolishness used to be as alien and distant to him as the moon.”, what does “businesses” most nearly mean?
   A. places where goods are kept
   B. acting too quickly
   C. jobs and daily affairs
   D. surround so as to force to give up
7. In the line “Kamaswami told him about his trade, showed him the merchandise and storage rooms, showed him calculations.”, what does “storage” most nearly mean?
   A. acting too quickly
   B. jobs and daily affairs
   C. surround so as to force to give up
   D. places where goods are kept

Answer key: 1. A (As a game he does not take seriously); 2. A (The childlike people); 3. A (Irritated but impressed by results); 4. B (Neither can truly love); 5. A (He is slowly becoming like them); 6. C (jobs and daily affairs); 7. D (places where goods are kept)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “With the Childlike People,” how does Hesse show detachment among the childlike people? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In With the Childlike People, how does Hesse develop the idea of detachment among the childlike people? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how With the Childlike People develops the idea of detachment among the childlike people. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of With the Childlike People (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of detachment among the childlike people. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what With the Childlike People suggests about detachment among the childlike people. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in With the Childlike People to complicate the reader's understanding of detachment among the childlike people. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate With the Childlike People within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of detachment among the childlike people responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read With the Childlike People alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of detachment among the childlike people follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to With the Childlike People and its treatment of detachment among the childlike people. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads With the Childlike People as evidence for a larger claim about detachment among the childlike people in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads With the Childlike People as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of detachment among the childlike people. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *But like this, I've had a few good days, I've learned, had joy, I've neither harmed myself nor others by annoyance and hastiness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "hastiness" most nearly mean?

   A. floor covering consisting of a piece of thick heavy fabric (usually with nap or pile)

   B. transport commercially

C. steadiness of mind under stress

D. acting too quickly

2. *"It is very good, sir. When a person has nothing to eat, fasting is the smartest thing he could do. When, for example, Siddhartha hadn't learned to fast, he would have to accept any kind of service before that day is up, whether it may be with you or wherever, because hunger would force him to do so. But like this, Siddhartha can wait calmly, he knows no impatience, he knows no emergency, for a long time he can allow hunger to besiege him and can laugh about it. This, sir, is what fasting is good for."*

Which choice best states a central concern of "With the Childlike People"?

A. Wisdom cannot be taught

B. Detachment among the childlike people

C. The teacher and the teaching

D. Despair and renewal by the river

SAT key: 1. D (acting too quickly); 2. B (Detachment among the childlike people)

Lesson 7: Sansara

Focus: the cycle of desire

Content note (gambling, drinking, self-disgust): Siddhartha sinks into gambling, drink and self-disgust. Be mindful of students affected by addiction in their families.
Student preview: Siddhartha gambles and drinks and grows to hate his life.
Suggested language: "What has Siddhartha lost, and how does he realize it?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Over many years Siddhartha grows wealthy, gambles, drinks, and becomes greedy and weary—like the childlike people. Kamala tells him she wishes to learn about Gotama. After a dream of Kamala's songbird lying dead in its golden cage, Siddhartha feels disgust at his life and leaves the city without a word. Kamala, pregnant with his child, frees her bird.

Background: Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth.

Significance: The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the dead songbird symbolize? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Siddhartha gambles and drinks and grows to hate his life.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are gambled, castaway, demonstrating, mockingly, devious. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again." In this sentence it means: played games of chance for money. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Samsara (spelled 'Sansara' in this translation) is the cycle of birth, suffering and rebirth. Why does this chapter matter? The caged songbird is the book's clearest symbol of Siddhartha's trapped inner voice. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the cycle of desire? I circle "castaway", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find symbolism, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for symbolism.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness. Worthless, so it seemed to him, worthless and pointless was the way he had been going through life; nothing which was alive, nothing which was in some way delicious or worth keeping he had left in his hands. Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Theme, Tone / mood: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Sansara develops the idea of the cycle of desire. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the cycle of desire, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes the cycle of desire. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
gambled (verb)	played games of chance for money	*Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
castaway (noun)	a person left stranded after a shipwreck	*Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
demonstrating (verb)	showing clearly	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mockingly (adverb)	in a disrespectful jeering manner	*He played the game due to a pain of his heart, losing and wasting his wretched money in the game brought him an angry joy, in no other way he could demonstrate his disdain for wealth, the merchants' false god, more clearly and more mockingly.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
devious (adjective)	indirect in departing from the accepted or proper way; misleading	*On a strange and devious way, Siddhartha had gotten into this final and most base of all dependencies, by means of the game of dice.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
zealously (adverb)	in a zealous manner	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
debtors (noun)	a person who owes a creditor; someone who has the obligation of paying a debt	*And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
reliable (adjective)	worthy of reliance or trust	*He only noticed that this bright and reliable voice inside of him, which had awoken in him at that time and had ever guided him in his best times, had become silent.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
encompassed (verb)	surrounded	*Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
poultry (noun)			

	chickens, ducks and similar birds raised for food	*He had learned to eat tenderly and carefully prepared food, even fish, even meat and poultry, spices and sweets, and to drink wine, which causes sloth and forgetfulness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the dead songbird symbolize?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city?
   A. He becomes a ferryman
   B. He becomes poor
   C. He becomes greedy and weary
   D. He becomes a holy man
2. What does Siddhartha dream about?
   A. Kamala's songbird dead in its cage
   B. His father's house
   C. A river in flood
   D. Govinda dying
3. How does Siddhartha leave the city?
   A. With a farewell feast
   B. On a ship
   C. Suddenly, without a word
   D. With Kamala
4. What does Kamala do after he leaves?
   A. Follows him
   B. Burns her garden
   C. Frees her songbird
   D. Marries Kamaswami
5. What is Sansara?
   A. A city
   B. The cycle of suffering and rebirth
   C. A song

D. A river

6. In the line “Thus he gambled with high stakes and mercilessly, hating himself, mocking himself, won thousands, threw away thousands, lost money, lost jewelry, lost a house in the country, won again, lost again.”, what does “gambled” most nearly mean?
   A. in a disrespectful jeering manner
   B. played games of chance for money
   C. a person left stranded after a shipwreck
   D. showing clearly
7. In the line “Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.”, what does “castaway” most nearly mean?
   A. a person left stranded after a shipwreck
   B. played games of chance for money
   C. showing clearly
   D. in a disrespectful jeering manner

Answer key: 1. C (He becomes greedy and weary); 2. A (Kamala's songbird dead in its cage); 3. C (Suddenly, without a word); 4. C (Frees her songbird); 5. B (The cycle of suffering and rebirth); 6. B (played games of chance for money); 7. A (a person left stranded after a shipwreck)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Sansara,” how does Hesse show the cycle of desire? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Sansara, how does Hesse develop the idea of the cycle of desire? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Sansara develops the idea of the cycle of desire. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Sansara (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of the cycle of desire. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Sansara suggests about the cycle of desire. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in Sansara to complicate the reader's understanding of the cycle of desire. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Sansara within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the cycle of desire responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Sansara alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the cycle of desire follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Sansara and its treatment of the cycle of desire. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Sansara as evidence for a larger claim about the cycle of desire in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Sansara as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the cycle of desire. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *And after each big loss, his mind was set on new riches, pursued the trade more zealously, forced his debtors more strictly to pay, because he wanted to continue gambling, he wanted to continue squandering, continue demonstrating his disdain of wealth.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “demonstrating” most nearly mean?

   A. surrounded

   B. chickens, ducks and similar birds raised for food

   C. worthy of reliance or trust

D. showing clearly

2. *Starting up from this dream, he felt encompassed by a deep sadness. Worthless, so it seemed to him, worthless and pointless was the way he had been going through life; nothing which was alive, nothing which was in some way delicious or worth keeping he had left in his hands. Alone he stood there and empty like a castaway on the shore.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Sansara"?

A. The teacher and the teaching

B. Detachment among the childlike people

C. Learning from the river

D. The cycle of desire

SAT key: 1. D (showing clearly); 2. D (The cycle of desire)

Lesson 8: By the River

Focus: despair and renewal by the river

Content note (suicidal intent): At the river Siddhartha intends to end his life. Use the safe-messaging script; the quiz item asks what his despair leads him toward.
Student preview: Siddhartha feels deep despair and thinks about ending his life. If this is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor.
Suggested language: "What stops Siddhartha, and what does he feel afterward?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha reaches the river and, sick of himself, leans to drown. From deep within comes the sacred word Om, and he falls into a deep sleep under a coconut tree. He wakes renewed; Govinda, now a monk, has watched over him without recognizing him. Siddhartha reflects that he had to experience despair to learn its emptiness, and decides to stay by the river.

Background: Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality.

Significance: Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Siddhartha feels deep despair and thinks about ending his life. If this is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are rejuvenated, ointments, unlearn, sobering, vomiting. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!" In this sentence it means: made young or fresh again. Word histories: "rejuvenated": re- "again" + Latin juvenis "young" + -ate. "vomiting": From Latin vomitare, frequentative of vomere "to spew forth." (Not from mittere "to send.") For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Om is the sacred syllable in Hindu and Buddhist traditions, representing ultimate reality. Why does this chapter matter? Rebirth by water is a classic archetype; the river becomes the novel's central symbol. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Siddhartha was deeply shocked." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to despair and renewal by the river? I circle "sobering", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find symbolism, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for symbolism.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Siddhartha was deeply shocked. So this was how things were with him, so doomed was he, so much he had lost his way and was forsaken by all knowledge, that he had been able to seek death, that this wish, this wish of a child, had been able to grow in him: to find rest by annihilating his body! What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Imagery, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how By the River develops the idea of despair and renewal by the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about despair and renewal by the river, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes despair and renewal by the river. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
rejuvenated (verb)	made young or fresh again	*Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!*	"rejuvenated": re- "again" + Latin juvenis "young" + -ate. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/rejuvenate)
ointments (noun)	perfumed oils and creams	*There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unlearn (verb)	to forget a habit or way of thinking	*I had to spend many years losing my spirit, to unlearn thinking again, to forget the oneness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sobering (verb)	cause to become sober	*What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vomiting (verb)	eject the contents of the stomach through the mouth	*This was the great vomiting he had longed for: death, the smashing to bits of the form he hated!*	"vomiting": From Latin vomitare, frequentative of vomere "to spew forth." (Not from mittere "to send.") (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/vomit)
penitents (noun)	people who punish themselves for their sins	*But as a young man, I followed the penitents, lived in the forest, suffered of heat and frost, learned to hunger, taught my body to become dead.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
smashing (noun)	breaking into pieces	*This was the great vomiting he had longed for: death, the smashing to bits of the form he hated!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wrestled (verb)	combat to overcome an	*Was this not his self, his small, frightened, and proud self, he had wrestled with for so many years, which*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

	opposing tendency or force	*had defeated him again and again, which was back again after every killing, prohibited joy, felt fear?*	
annihilate (verb)	to destroy completely	*There was nothing left for him, except to annihilate himself, except to smash the failure into which he had shaped his life, to throw it away, before the feet of mockingly laughing gods.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
collapsed (verb)	break down, literally or metaphorically	*By the foot of the coconut tree, Siddhartha collapsed, struck down by tiredness, mumbling Om, placed his head on the root of the tree and fell into a deep sleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Siddhartha say he had to experience despair himself?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the unity of all things?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What does Siddhartha's despair lead him toward at the river?
   A. Crossing it
   B. Fishing
   C. Bathing
   D. Ending his life in the water
2. What stops him?
   A. A child
   B. A shout from Govinda
   C. The word Om rising within
   D. A storm
3. Who watches over him while he sleeps?
   A. Vasudeva
   B. Kamaswami
   C. Govinda
   D. Kamala

4. Does Govinda recognize him at first?
   A. Only by voice
   B. Only by his clothes
   C. No
   D. Yes immediately
5. What does Siddhartha decide?
   A. To stay by the river
   B. To return to the city
   C. To join the monks
   D. To go home
6. In the line “Never before by sleep, he had been thus refreshed, thus renewed, thus rejuvenated!”, what does “rejuvenated” most nearly mean?
   A. to forget a habit or way of thinking
   B. made young or fresh again
   C. perfumed oils and creams
   D. cause to become sober
7. In the line “There, where I ran away from, there everything smelled of ointments, of spices, of wine, of excess, of sloth.”, what does “ointments” most nearly mean?
   A. to forget a habit or way of thinking
   B. cause to become sober
   C. perfumed oils and creams
   D. made young or fresh again

Answer key: 1. D (Ending his life in the water); 2. C (The word Om rising within); 3. C (Govinda); 4. C (No); 5. A (To stay by the river); 6. B (made young or fresh again); 7. C (perfumed oils and creams)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “By the River,” how does Hesse show despair and renewal by the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In By the River, how does Hesse develop the idea of despair and renewal by the river? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how By the River develops the idea of despair and renewal by the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery

shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of By the River (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of despair and renewal by the river. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what By the River suggests about despair and renewal by the river. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in By the River to complicate the reader's understanding of despair and renewal by the river. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate By the River within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of despair and renewal by the river responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read By the River alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of despair and renewal by the river follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to By the River and its treatment of despair and renewal by the river. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads By the River as evidence for a larger claim about despair and renewal by the river in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads By the River as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of despair and renewal by the river. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist,

psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had to spend many years losing my spirit, to unlearn thinking again, to forget the oneness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "unlearn" most nearly mean?

   A. to forget a habit or way of thinking
   B. to destroy completely
   C. break down, literally or metaphorically
   D. combat to overcome an opposing tendency or force

2. *Siddhartha was deeply shocked. So this was how things were with him, so doomed was he, so much he had lost his way and was forsaken by all knowledge, that he had been able to seek death, that this wish, this wish of a child, had been able to grow in him: to find rest by annihilating his body! What all agony of these recent times, all sobering realizations, all desperation had not brought about, this was brought on by this moment, when the Om entered his consciousness: he became aware of himself in his misery and in his error.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "By the River"?

   A. Awakening to the world
   B. Hearing the many voices
   C. Entering the city and learning love
   D. Despair and renewal by the river

SAT key: 1. A (to forget a habit or way of thinking); 2. D (Despair and renewal by the river)

Lesson 9: The Ferryman

Focus: learning from the river

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha becomes Vasudeva's assistant. Vasudeva, a simple and attentive listener, teaches him to listen to the river, which shows that there is no such thing as time—the river is everywhere at once. Years pass peacefully. Gotama's monks pass by, carrying news that the Buddha is dying, and Kamala travels with her son to see him; she is bitten by a snake, recognizes Siddhartha at the ferry, and dies in his arms. Siddhartha keeps their son.

Background: The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice.

Significance: The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: What does the river teach that no person could? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are obstructing, precocious, ferried, oarsman, wondrously. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman's job was to get them quickly across that obstacle." In this sentence it means: blocking. Word histories: "ferried": From Old English ferian "to carry, transport," a Germanic word related to fare. (Not from Latin ferre.) For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. The image of the river echoes ancient ideas, such as Heraclitus's saying that one cannot step into the same river twice. Why does this chapter matter? The listening river replaces human teachers; Kamala's peaceful death and the son's arrival begin a new test. Write down one question you want answered.*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: ""Now I recognise you,"" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to learning from the river? I circle "ferried", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find symbolism, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for symbolism.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *"Now I recognise you," he finally said. "At one time, you've slept in my hut, this was a long time ago, possibly more than twenty years ago, and you've been ferried across the river by me, and we parted like good friends. Haven't you been a Samana? I can't think of your name any more."*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Characterization, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how The Ferryman develops the idea of learning from the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about learning from the river, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes learning from the river. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
obstructing (verb)	blocking	*They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman's job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
precocious (adjective)	too grown-up for one's age	*They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ferried (verb)	carried across water by boat	*Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.*	"ferried": From Old English ferian "to carry, transport," a Germanic word related to fare. (Not from Latin ferre.) (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/ferry)
oarsman (noun)	someone who rows a boat	*The rich and elegant Siddhartha is becoming an oarsman's servant, the learned Brahmin Siddhartha becomes a ferryman: this has also been told to you by the river.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wondrously (adverb)	extremely well	*He looked up and first saw the boy's face, which wondrously reminded him of something, like a warning to remember something he had forgotten.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
birthplace (noun)	the place where someone was born	*Listening carefully, he let everything enter his mind, birthplace and childhood, all that learning, all that searching, all joy, all distress.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
singsong (noun)	a regular and monotonous rising and falling intonation	*And with that singsong, the boy became calm, was only now and then uttering a sob and fell asleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
oneness (noun)	the quality of being united into one	*A lot it has told me, deeply it has filled me with the healing thought, with the thought of oneness."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chewing (verb)	chew (food); to bite and grind with the teeth	*She, Kamala herself, had also become tired, and while the boy was chewing a banana, she crouched*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		down on the ground, closed her eyes a bit, and rested.	
floating (adjective)	drifting on water	*Bright pearls he saw rising from the deep, quiet bubbles of air floating on the reflecting surface, the blue of the sky being depicted in it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the river teach that no person could?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the river and time?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become?
   A. Kamaswami's
   B. Gotama's
   C. Vasudeva's
   D. Govinda's
2. What is Vasudeva's greatest skill?
   A. Preaching
   B. Listening
   C. Bargaining
   D. Fighting
3. What does the river teach about time?
   A. That time is cruel
   B. That time is short
   C. That time does not truly exist
   D. That time is money
4. How is Kamala hurt?
   A. She falls in the river
   B. She is bitten by a snake
   C. She catches fever
   D. She is robbed

5. Who stays with Siddhartha after Kamala dies?
   A. Their son
   B. Kamaswami
   C. Gotama
   D. Govinda
6. In the line “They travelled to seek money and business, and for weddings, and on pilgrimages, and the river was obstructing their path, and the ferryman’s job was to get them quickly across that obstacle.”, what does “obstructing” most nearly mean?
   A. someone who rows a boat
   B. carried across water by boat
   C. too grown-up for one's age
   D. blocking
7. In the line “They had been, so it seemed to him, proud and precocious words; with a smile, he remembered them.”, what does “precocious” most nearly mean?
   A. blocking
   B. someone who rows a boat
   C. carried across water by boat
   D. too grown-up for one's age

Answer key: 1. C (Vasudeva's); 2. B (Listening); 3. C (That time does not truly exist); 4. B (She is bitten by a snake); 5. A (Their son); 6. D (blocking); 7. D (too grown-up for one's age)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Ferryman,” how does Hesse show learning from the river? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In The Ferryman, how does Hesse develop the idea of learning from the river? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Ferryman develops the idea of learning from the river. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Ferryman (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of learning from the river. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Ferryman suggests about learning from the river. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in The Ferryman to complicate the reader's understanding of learning from the river. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Ferryman within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of learning from the river responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Ferryman alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of learning from the river follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Ferryman and its treatment of learning from the river. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Ferryman as evidence for a larger claim about learning from the river in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Ferryman as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of learning from the river. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Behold, once before you have ferried me across this water in your boat for the immaterial reward of a good deed.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "ferried" most nearly mean?

   A. drifting on water
   B. the quality of being united into one
   C. carried across water by boat
   D. chew (food); to bite and grind with the teeth

2. *"Now I recognise you," he finally said. "At one time, you've slept in my hut, this was a long time ago, possibly more than twenty years ago, and you've been ferried across the river by me, and we parted like good friends. Haven't you been a Samana? I can't think of your name any more."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "The Ferryman"?

   A. Self-denial as a path
   B. Awakening to the world
   C. Learning from the river
   D. The pain of a father's love

SAT key: 1. C (carried across water by boat); 2. C (Learning from the river)

Lesson 10: The Son

Focus: the pain of a father's love

Content note (family conflict): Siddhartha's son rejects and robs him. The vocabulary list no longer includes "fornicator".
Student preview: Siddhartha's son rebels against him.
Suggested language: "Why can't Siddhartha teach his son what he learned?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Siddhartha's spoiled son, raised in wealth, despises the ferry life and his father's gentleness. Vasudeva advises letting the boy return to the world, but Siddhartha cannot let go. The son finally runs away, stealing the ferry money. Siddhartha follows to the city and stops at Kamala's old garden, realizing he must not pursue him. Vasudeva brings him home.

Background: This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves.

Significance: Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board. Before we start, a content note: Siddhartha's son rebels against him.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are reciprocate, ranting, soiling, burdening, exuberant. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it." In this sentence it means: to return (a feeling). Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. This chapter reverses Chapter One: now Siddhartha is the father whose son leaves. Why does this chapter matter? Siddhartha experiences foolish, painful love—the very attachment he once found childlike. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for characterization.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to the pain of a father's love? I circle "reciprocate", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find characterization, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for characterization.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of characterization. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it. For long months, Vasudeva waited, watching, waited and said nothing. One day, when Siddhartha the younger had once again tormented his father very much with spite and an unsteadiness in his wishes and had broken both of his rice bowls, Vasudeva took in the evening his friend aside and talked to him.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Characterization, Irony, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how The Son develops the idea of the pain of a father's love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about the pain of a father's love, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the pain of a father's love. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
reciprocate (verb)	to return (a feeling)	*For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ranting (adjective)	loud and angry	*"I must follow him," said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
soiling (verb)	making dirty	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
burdening (verb)	weight down with a load	*Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
exuberant (adjective)	joyously unrestrained	*Won't he become exuberant, won't he lose himself to pleasure and power, won't he repeat all of his father's mistakes, won't he perhaps get entirely lost in Sansara?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
thumped (verb)	hit hard with a dull sound	*But the boy did not leave the hut, in stubborn disobedience and rage he stayed where he was, thumped on the ground with his feet, clenched his fists, and screamed in a powerful outburst his hatred and contempt into his father's face.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
humiliate (verb)	cause to feel shame; hurt the pride of	*Through all this, the son let him commit his foolish acts, let him court for his affection, let him humiliate himself every day by giving in to his moods.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
warnings (noun)	a message informing of danger	*Were his father's religious devotion, his teachers warnings, his own knowledge, his own search able to keep him safe?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enriched (verb)	make better or improve in quality	*Now he too felt, late, once in his lifetime, this strongest and strangest of all passions, suffered from it, suffered miserably, and was nevertheless in bliss, was nevertheless renewed in one respect, enriched by one thing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
		By means of teachings, prayer, admonition?	

admonition (noun)	cautionary advice about something imminent (especially imminent danger or other unpleasantness)		Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Siddhartha's situation mirror his own father's?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with love and attachment?

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. How does the son treat Siddhartha?
   A. With contempt
   B. With fear
   C. With silence
   D. With love
2. What does Vasudeva advise?
   A. Punish him
   B. Let the boy go into the world
   C. Lock him up
   D. Send him to monks
3. What does the son steal?
   A. Food
   B. A boat only
   C. Kamala's ring
   D. The ferry money
4. Where does Siddhartha go in pursuit?
   A. To the city and Kamala's old garden
   B. To his father's house
   C. To the mountains
   D. To Gotama's grove
5. What is ironic about Siddhartha's pain?
   A. He forgets the boy
   B. He becomes rich

C. He now feels the attachment he once called childlike

D. He is happy

6. In the line “For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it.”, what does “reciprocate” most nearly mean?

A. to return (a feeling)

B. making dirty

C. loud and angry

D. weight down with a load

7. In the line ““I must follow him,” said Siddhartha, who had been shivering with grief since those ranting speeches the boy had made yesterday.”, what does “ranting” most nearly mean?

A. loud and angry

B. weight down with a load

C. to return (a feeling)

D. making dirty

Answer key: 1. A (With contempt); 2. B (Let the boy go into the world); 3. D (The ferry money); 4. A (To the city and Kamala's old garden); 5. C (He now feels the attachment he once called childlike); 6. A (to return (a feeling)); 7. A (loud and angry)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Son,” how does Hesse show the pain of a father's love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In The Son, how does Hesse develop the idea of the pain of a father's love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how The Son develops the idea of the pain of a father's love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of The Son (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the pain of a father's love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what The Son suggests about the pain of a father's love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses characterization in The Son to complicate the reader's understanding of the pain of a father's love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate The Son within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the pain of a father's love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read The Son alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the pain of a father's love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Son and its treatment of the pain of a father's love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads The Son as evidence for a larger claim about the pain of a father's love in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads The Son as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the pain of a father's love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Which father, which teacher had been able to protect him from living his life for himself, from soiling himself with life, from burdening himself with guilt, from drinking the bitter drink for himself, from finding his path for himself?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “soiling” most nearly mean?

   A. cautionary advice about something imminent (especially imminent danger or other unpleasantness)

   B. make better or improve in quality

   C. making dirty

D. a message informing of danger

2. *For a long time, for long months, Siddhartha waited for his son to understand him, to accept his love, to perhaps reciprocate it. For long months, Vasudeva waited, watching, waited and said nothing. One day, when Siddhartha the younger had once again tormented his father very much with spite and an unsteadiness in his wishes and had broken both of his rice bowls, Vasudeva took in the evening his friend aside and talked to him.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "The Son"?

A. The pain of a father's love

B. Entering the city and learning love

C. Self-denial as a path

D. Hearing the many voices

SAT key: 1. C (making dirty); 2. A (The pain of a father's love)

Lesson 11: Om

Focus: hearing the many voices

Teacher only · spoilers

Still aching for his son, Siddhartha sees his reflection resemble his own father and understands the circle of suffering. He confesses everything to Vasudeva, who leads him to listen; the river's voices—joy and sorrow, good and evil—blend into one word, Om. Siddhartha achieves serenity. Vasudeva, his work done, walks into the forest to die.

Background: Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism.

Significance: The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Settle in and write for five minutes: What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.*

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
> *Today's words are blossomed, fateful, ferryboat, ripened, embarrassing. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was." In this sentence it means: developed; grew and flourished. Word histories: "ferryboat": ferry, from Old English ferian "to carry, transport," + boat. For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.*

> **18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
> Present the historical and literary background.
> *Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. Hesse blends Hindu and Buddhist ideas of unity with Western mysticism. Why does this chapter matter? The climax: all opposites unite into one harmony, and the student becomes the master. Write down one question you want answered.*

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for symbolism.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was." I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to hearing the many voices? I circle "blossomed", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find symbolism, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for symbolism.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of symbolism. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was. It was nothing but a readiness of the soul, an ability, a secret art, to think every moment, while living his life, the thought of oneness, to be able to feel and inhale the oneness. Slowly this blossomed in him, was shining back at him from Vasudeva's old, childlike face: harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness.*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Symbolism, Imagery, Theme: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Om develops the idea of hearing the many voices. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about hearing the many voices, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes hearing the many voices. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
blossomed (verb)	developed; grew and flourished	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fateful (adjective)	decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end	*Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ferryboat (noun)	a boat that carries people across water	*He no longer used the ferryboat, his eyes were starting to get weak, and not just his eyes; his arms and hands as well.*	“ferryboat”: ferry, from Old English ferian "to carry, transport," + boat. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/ferry)
ripened (verb)	cause to ripen or develop fully	*Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
embarrassing (verb)	cause to be embarrassed; cause to feel self-conscious	*He reported everything, he was able to say everything, even the most embarrassing parts, everything could be said, everything shown, everything he could tell.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
nurtured (verb)	help develop, help grow	*But the wound still burned, longingly and bitterly Siddhartha thought of his son, nurtured his love and tenderness in his heart, allowed the pain to gnaw at him, committed all foolish acts of love.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
runaway (noun)	a person who has run away	*He presented his wound, also told how he fled today, how he ferried across the water, a childish runaway, willing to walk to the city, how the river had laughed.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
resounded (verb)	ring or echo with sound	*It still resounded, full of suffering, searching, but other voices joined it, voices of joy and of suffering, good and bad voices, laughing and sad ones, a hundred voices, a thousand voices.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bathing (verb)		*To show his wound to this listener was the same as bathing it in the river,*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

	cleanse the entire body	*until it had cooled and become one with the river.*	
weaving (verb)	interlace by or as if by weaving	*Vasudeva was sitting in the hut and weaving a basket.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does Siddhartha finally understand when he hears all the voices together?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the search for self-knowledge?

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble?
   A. His father
   B. His son
   C. Govinda
   D. Gotama
2. Whom does he confess everything to?
   A. The river god
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Kamala
   D. Govinda
3. What do all the river's voices become?
   A. Silence
   B. A song of war
   C. The single word Om
   D. His son's voice
4. What state does Siddhartha reach?
   A. Confusion
   B. Anger
   C. Serenity
   D. Despair
5. What does Vasudeva do afterward?
   A. Takes a new boat
   B. Walks into the forest to die

C. Leaves for the city

D. Becomes a monk

6. In the line “Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?

A. a boat that carries people across water

B. cause to ripen or develop fully

C. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

D. developed; grew and flourished

7. In the line “Was it not a comedy, a strange and stupid matter, this repetition, this running around in a fateful circle?”, what does “fateful” most nearly mean?

A. a boat that carries people across water

B. developed; grew and flourished

C. cause to ripen or develop fully

D. decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end

Answer key: 1. A (His father); 2. B (Vasudeva); 3. C (The single word Om); 4. C (Serenity); 5. B (Walks into the forest to die); 6. D (developed; grew and flourished); 7. D (decided by fate; leading to an unhappy end)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Om,” how does Hesse show hearing the many voices? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Om, how does Hesse develop the idea of hearing the many voices? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Om develops the idea of hearing the many voices. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Om (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of hearing the many voices. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Om suggests about hearing the many voices. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses symbolism in Om to complicate the reader's understanding of hearing the many voices. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Om within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of hearing the many voices responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Om alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of hearing the many voices follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Om and its treatment of hearing the many voices. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Om as evidence for a larger claim about hearing the many voices in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Om as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of hearing the many voices. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *He no longer used the ferryboat, his eyes were starting to get weak, and not just his eyes; his arms and hands as well.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ferryboat” most nearly mean?

   A. ring or echo with sound

   B. a boat that carries people across water

   C. interlace by or as if by weaving

   D. cleanse the entire body

2. *Slowly blossomed, slowly ripened in Siddhartha the realisation, the knowledge, what wisdom actually was, what the goal of his long search was. It was nothing but a readiness of the soul, an ability, a secret art, to think every moment, while living his life, the thought of oneness, to be able to feel and inhale the oneness. Slowly this blossomed in him, was shining back at him from Vasudeva's old, childlike face: harmony, knowledge of the eternal perfection of the world, smiling, oneness.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Om"?

A. Hearing the many voices

B. Restlessness despite privilege

C. Entering the city and learning love

D. The pain of a father's love

SAT key: 1. B (a boat that carries people across water); 2. A (Hearing the many voices)

Lesson 12: Govinda

Focus: wisdom cannot be taught

Teacher only · spoilers

Old Govinda, still searching, comes to the ferry and asks for teaching. Siddhartha says that wisdom cannot be communicated in words, that every truth's opposite is also true, and that one must love the world. Asked to kiss Siddhartha's forehead, Govinda sees in his face a stream of countless faces and forms—the unity of all things—and bows, weeping, before his friend's smile.

Background: The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality.

Significance: The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Respond in writing to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Settle in and write for five minutes: Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more? No wrong answers yet; we will test these ideas against the text. Two volunteers share, and I note key words on the board.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Introduce 5 key words: pronounce, define from context, then the word's history.
Today's words are insights, benevolently, searcher, bizarre, progressed. For each one we read the sentence, guess from context and then check the definition. Here is the first: "But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?" In this sentence it means: understandings; realizations. Word histories: For the other words, look up the word history (Etymonline or the OED) and record the language of origin and the root meaning in your etymology log.

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Present the historical and literary background.
Here is what the first readers of Siddhartha would have known. The ending echoes Buddhist ideas of non-self and the Hindu idea of the oneness of reality. Why does this chapter matter? The final image, Siddhartha's smile resembling Gotama's, suggests he has found his own path to enlightenment. Write down one question you want answered.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Teacher models a think-aloud on the anchor passage for theme.
Watch me read this the way a careful reader does. The passage opens: "He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: "You're very good to us monks and pilgrims, you have already ferried many of us acro" I stop and ask: what is the author doing here, and how does it connect to wisdom cannot be taught? I circle "searcher", one of today's words, and ask why the author chose it over a plainer word. When I find theme, I underline it and write its effect in the margin, then I check my idea against the next sentence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Read the anchor passage aloud together; annotate for theme.
Now we do it together. I read the first sentence and you track along. Mark every example of theme. Turn to a partner: what does the author want us to notice? I will collect three ideas and we choose the strongest using evidence.

> *He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: "You're very good to us monks and pilgrims, you have already ferried many of us across the river. Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Students annotate a new passage independently in the reader, then begin the writing prompt at their assigned rigor level.
Your turn. Annotate the next page in the app for Theme, Characterization, Irony: at least three marks with a margin note each. Then open your writing prompt; the app shows the level your teacher assigned (for a 9–10 class, the HS Sophomore prompt reads: Analyze how Govinda develops the idea of wisdom cannot be taught. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)) I will circulate and conference.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion (think-pair-share or a short Socratic circle).
Let's talk. Our question: How does this chapter connect to the search for self-knowledge? Every claim needs a page reference. Respond to the person before you by agreeing, extending or challenging with evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app, then a one-sentence exit ticket.
Take the chapter quiz in the app. Then, in one sentence, tell me what this chapter suggests about wisdom cannot be taught, backed by one short quotation.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes wisdom cannot be taught. Tonight, read the next chapter and add two words to your etymology log.

Total: 90 minutes.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
insights (noun)	understandings; realizations	*But haven't you found something by yourself, though you've found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
benevolently (adverb)	in a kind, well-meaning way	*The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
searcher (noun)	a person who searches	*Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bizarre (adjective)	conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual	*(But secretly he thought to himself: This Siddhartha is a bizarre person, he expresses bizarre thoughts, his teachings sound foolish.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
progressed (verb)	moved forward; advanced	*It is not possible for any person to see how far another one has already progressed on his path; in the robber and dice-gambler, the Buddha is waiting; in the Brahmin, the robber is waiting.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tolerance (noun)	willingness to accept others' beliefs or ways	*He commands benevolence, clemency, sympathy, tolerance, but not love; he forbade us to tie our heart in love to earthly things."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
simultaneous (adjective)	occurring or operating at the same time	*In deep meditation, there is the possibility to put time out of existence, to see all life which was, is, and will be as if it was simultaneous, and there everything is good, everything is perfect, everything is Brahman.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
incarnation (noun)	a lifetime in a particular body	*It is unlikely for one of us to see the other again in this incarnation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
predecessor (noun)	one who precedes you in time (as in holding a position or office)	*But most of all, I have learned here from this river and from my predecessor, the ferryman Vasudeva.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
developing (verb)	growing; changing over time	*The sinner is not on his way to become a Buddha, he is not in the process of developing, though our capacity for thinking does not know how else to picture these things.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Govinda followed a teacher all his life; Siddhartha followed experience. Who learned more?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with experience versus teaching?

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who comes to the ferry at the end?
   A. Govinda
   B. Gotama
   C. Siddhartha's son
   D. Kamala
2. What does Siddhartha say about wisdom?
   A. It cannot be taught in words
   B. It is useless
   C. It is in books
   D. It belongs to monks
3. What does Siddhartha say one must do with the world?
   A. Escape it
   B. Love it
   C. Rule it
   D. Ignore it
4. What does Govinda see in Siddhartha's face?
   A. Fire
   B. Countless faces and forms flowing together
   C. Only an old man
   D. His own father
5. Whose smile does Siddhartha's resemble?
   A. His son's
   B. Kamala's
   C. Gotama's
   D. Vasudeva's only

6. In the line “But haven’t you found something by yourself, though you’ve found no teachings, you still found certain thoughts, certain insights, which are your own and which help you to live?”, what does “insights” most nearly mean?
   A. in a kind, well-meaning way
   B. a person who searches
   C. understandings; realizations
   D. conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual
7. In the line “The face was unchanged, after under its surface the depth of the thousandfoldness had closed up again, he smiled silently, smiled quietly and softly, perhaps very benevolently, perhaps very mockingly, precisely as he used to smile, the exalted one.”, what does “benevolently” most nearly mean?
   A. understandings; realizations
   B. in a kind, well-meaning way
   C. conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual
   D. a person who searches

Answer key: 1. A (Govinda); 2. A (It cannot be taught in words); 3. B (Love it); 4. B (Countless faces and forms flowing together); 5. C (Gotama's); 6. C (understandings; realizations); 7. B (in a kind, well-meaning way)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Govinda,” how does Hesse show wisdom cannot be taught? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): In Govinda, how does Hesse develop the idea of wisdom cannot be taught? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Govinda develops the idea of wisdom cannot be taught. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim. (You are reading the English translation by Gunther Olesch, Anke Dreher, Amy Coulter, Stefan Langer and Semyon Chaichenets, so word-choice evidence is the translators' English.)

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO3): Analyze how the structure of Govinda (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of wisdom cannot be taught. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO5): Two readers disagree about what Govinda suggests about wisdom cannot be taught. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Hermann Hesse uses theme in Govinda to complicate the reader's understanding of wisdom cannot be taught. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Govinda within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of wisdom cannot be taught responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Govinda alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of wisdom cannot be taught follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Govinda and its treatment of wisdom cannot be taught. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Govinda as evidence for a larger claim about wisdom cannot be taught in Siddhartha. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Govinda as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of wisdom cannot be taught. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Siddhartha.

SAT-style questions

1. *Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

   As used in the text, what does the word "searcher" most nearly mean?

   A. a lifetime in a particular body

   B. one who precedes you in time (as in holding a position or office)

   C. growing; changing over time

   D. a person who searches

2. *He came to the river and asked the old man to ferry him over, and when they got off the boat on the other side, he said to the old man: "You're very good to us monks and pilgrims, you have already ferried many of us across the river. Aren't you too, ferryman, a searcher for the right path?"*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Govinda"?

A. Wisdom cannot be taught

B. Entering the city and learning love

C. The teacher and the teaching

D. Restlessness despite privilege

SAT key: 1. D (a person who searches); 2. A (Wisdom cannot be taught)

Whole-book test

Siddhartha: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. What is Siddhartha's family background?
   A. He is a merchant's son
   B. He is the son of a Brahmin
   C. He is a ferryman's son
   D. He is a prince
2. What do the Samanas practice?
   A. Farming
   B. Fasting and self-denial
   C. Warfare
   D. Trading goods
3. Where do they hear Gotama teach?
   A. In a city market
   B. In a palace
   C. By the river
   D. In the grove of Jetavana
4. What does Siddhartha resolve to learn from?
   A. His father
   B. The Samanas
   C. Himself
   D. The Buddha
5. Who ferries Siddhartha across the river?
   A. Govinda
   B. Vasudeva
   C. Kamaswami
   D. Gotama
6. How does Siddhartha treat business?
   A. As a game he does not take seriously
   B. As sacred work
   C. As a burden he hates
   D. As a way to help the poor
7. What happens to Siddhartha over the years in the city?
   A. He becomes a ferryman

B. He becomes poor

C. He becomes greedy and weary

D. He becomes a holy man

8. What does Siddhartha's despair lead him toward at the river?

A. Crossing it

B. Fishing

C. Bathing

D. Ending his life in the water

9. Whose assistant does Siddhartha become?

A. Kamaswami's

B. Gotama's

C. Vasudeva's

D. Govinda's

10. How does the son treat Siddhartha?

A. With contempt

B. With fear

C. With silence

D. With love

11. Whom does Siddhartha's reflection resemble?

A. His father

B. His son

C. Govinda

D. Gotama

12. Who comes to the ferry at the end?

A. Govinda

B. Gotama

C. Siddhartha's son

D. Kamala

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how the search for self-knowledge develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
2. Explain how experience versus teaching develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
3. Explain how the unity of all things develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the novel's central concerns (the search for self-knowledge, experience versus teaching, the unity of all things, the river and time, love and attachment) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. B (He is the son of a Brahmin); 2. B (Fasting and self-denial); 3. D (In the grove of Jetavana); 4. C (Himself); 5. B (Vasudeva); 6. A (As a game he does not take seriously); 7. C (He becomes greedy and weary); 8. D (Ending his life in the water); 9. C (Vasudeva's); 10. A (With contempt); 11. A (His father); 12. A (Govinda)

Essay assignments

Essay: The search for self-knowledge

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the search for self-knowledge. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the search for self-knowledge across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the search for self-knowledge. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the search for self-knowledge, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the search for self-knowledge in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha. Name your critical

method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the search for self-knowledge in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Experience versus teaching

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about experience versus teaching. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops experience versus teaching in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops experience versus teaching across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of experience versus teaching. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of experience versus teaching in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of experience versus teaching, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of experience versus teaching in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on experience versus teaching in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on experience versus teaching in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about experience versus teaching in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on experience versus teaching in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The unity of all things

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the unity of all things. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops the unity of all things in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the unity of all things across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the unity of all things. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the unity of all things in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the unity of all things, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the unity of all things in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the unity of all things in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the unity of all things in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the unity of all things in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the unity of all things in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The river and time

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about the river and time. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops the river and time in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops the river and time across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the river and time. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the river and time in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the river and time, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of the river and time in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the river and time in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the river and time in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the river and time in Siddhartha, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the river and time in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Love and attachment

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Siddhartha teaches about love and attachment. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Hermann Hesse develops love and attachment in Siddhartha. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Hermann Hesse develops love and attachment across Siddhartha. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO2): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Siddhartha (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of love and attachment. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO5): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of love and attachment in Siddhartha. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1; Cambridge International: CAIE-9695.AO3, CAIE-9695.AO4): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Hermann Hesse's choices in Siddhartha (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of love and attachment, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Siddhartha's treatment of love and attachment in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on love and attachment in Siddhartha that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on love and attachment in Siddhartha. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about love and attachment in Siddhartha, engaging at

least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Liber et Libri program outcomes: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on love and attachment in Siddhartha, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.